UNIT 1: BEGINNING YOUR JOURNEY, CAREER READINESS ORIENTATION

TOPIC 8: GOAL SETTING/SUCCESS

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Explore what success means to them
- Understand the difference between short-term, long-term and transitional goals
- Understand the importance of planning, preparation and practice in reaching goals

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Draw what success looks like to them
- Create specific, measurable, action-oriented short term goals with clear timelines
- Identify and prioritize five long term goals

Topic ACTIVITIES:

I. Welcome to the Day

Opening Questions:

- How do you define success?
- What is something you want to accomplish in the next year?

Real-World Application Check-in:

- Ask participants to share observations and thoughts.

Opening Quotes: Have students pick a quote out of a bag when they enter the room. During the introductions, have everyone read their quote. After each quote, give people about 15 seconds to think about the quote. After everyone has read their quote, pass out all of the quotes typed up to all of the participants.

1. "Though no one can go back and make a brand new start, anyone can start from now and make a brand new ending."
   ~ *Author Unknown*
2. "Some of the world's greatest feats were accomplished by people not smart enough to know they were impossible."
   ~ *Doug Larson* (columnist)
3. "I've missed more than 9000 shots in my career. I've lost almost 300 games. 26 times, I've been trusted to take the game winning shot and missed. I've failed over and over and over again in my life. And that is why I succeed."
   ~ *Michael Jordan* (NBA basketball player)
4. "Don't wait until everything is just right. It will never be perfect. There will always be challenges, obstacles and less than perfect conditions. So what. Get started now. With each step you take, you will grow stronger and stronger, more and more skilled, more and more self-confident and more and more successful."
   ~ *Mark Victor Hansen* (inspirational, motivational speaker, trainer and author)
5. "It takes 20 years to make an overnight success."
   ~ *Eddie Cantor* (comedian, dancer, singer-songwriter, actor)
6. "Success is not the key to happiness. Happiness is the key to success. If you love what you are doing, you will be successful."
   ~ *Herman Cain* (columnist, businessman, politician and radio talk-show host)
7. "One important key to success is self-confidence. An important key to self-confidence is preparation."
   ~ *Arthur Ashe* (professional tennis player and activist)
8. "Life's real failure is when you do not realize how close you were to success when you gave up."
   ~ *Anonymous*
9. "A successful man continues to look for work after he has found a job."
   ~ *Anonymous*

10. "Success is not permanent. The same is also true of failure."
    ~ *TS Elliot* (poet, playwright and literary critic)
11. "The secret of success in life is for a man to be ready for his opportunity when it comes."
    ~ *Benjamin Disraeli* (British prime minister and novelist)
12. "Keep these concepts in mind: You've failed many times, although you don't remember. You fell down the first time you tried to walk. You almost drowned the first time you tried to swim… Don't worry about failure. My suggestion to each of you: Worry about the chances you miss when you don't even try."
    ~ *Sherman Finesilver* (federal judge)
13. "No one ever attains very eminent success by simply doing what is required of him; it is the amount and excellence of what is over and above the required that determines the greatness of ultimate distinction."
    ~ *Charles Kendall Adams* (educator and historian)
14. "With some basic skills, ambition and persistence, then there is little limit to what you can achieve, and by trying you can often surprise yourself."
    ~ *Joe Gold* (founder of Gold's Gym and World Gym)
15. "If money is your hope for independence you will never have it. The only real security that a man will have in this world is a reserve of knowledge, experience, and ability."
    ~ *Henry Ford* (founder of Ford Motor Company and father of mass production assembly lines)
16. "Success doesn't come to you… you go to it."
    ~ *Marva Collins* (educator)
17. "Success is simply a matter of luck. Ask any failure."
    ~ *Earl Nightingale* (motivational speaker and author)
18. "To laugh often and much; To win the respect of intelligent people and the affection of children; To earn the approbation of honest critics and endure the betrayal of false friends; To appreciate beauty; To find the best in others; To give of one's self; To leave the world a bit better, whether by a healthy child, a garden patch, or a redeemed social condition; To have played and laughed with enthusiasm and sung with exultation; To know even one life has breathed easier because you have lived —This is to have succeeded."
    ~ *Ralph Waldo Emerson* (essayist, philosopher and poet)

II. Activity: Dice Racing

Supplies: Paper for each participant, one pen for each group, a pair of dice for each group

Directions:

- Goal: Be the first person to write all of the numbers 1-50 (or 1-100) on your paper (1, 2, 3, 4, 5… 50)
- Guidelines: There is only one pen/pencil per group. You only get the pen to write the numbers on your paper when you roll doubles. The first person rolls the dice. If she/he gets doubles she/he gets to take the pen and start writing on his/her paper. If she/he does not get doubles, the next person rolls the dice. As one person writes, the dice continue around the table with everyone rolling once until someone else rolls doubles. As soon as someone gets doubles, they say 'pen' and the person writing has to stop and pass the pen to the person who just rolled the doubles.
- When one person has the pen, everyone else is trying to work quickly as a team to roll the dice and get doubles to take the pen away. This dynamic of constantly shifting alliances makes the game really fun.

Adapted from http://www.teachmeteamwork.com/teachmeteamwork/2006/08/ teambuilding_ga_3.html
retrieved April 7, 2010

Discussion Questions:

1. What did you like about this activity? What did you dislike about this activity?
2. Why did (name) win — is she/he smarter than everyone else? More talented? More athletic? Better personality? (at some point someone will mention that it was luck)
3. Is the game only about luck? What if you could not write the numbers 1-(whatever number you used)? Would luck matter then?
4. What else is it about? (being prepared when an opportunity presents itself) People talk about being in the right place at the right time — but if they were not prepared to take advantage of the opportunity, it would not matter how often they were 'in the right place at the right time.' Do you think they were the only person at that place? They were the right person because they were prepared to perform, impress, and seal the deal.
5. You have the power and control to prepare yourself right now — for that future 'lucky' opportunity.

III. Success

- What is success?
- Identify 10 accomplishments (successes) from your life.
- What characteristics help people achieve success? What helped you in the examples of accomplishments that you just identified? (confidence, determination, motivation, practice, responsibility, positive attitude, believing you can do it, having a clear goal, etc.)
- What does success look like?

Drawing

Supplies: paper, pencils, pens, markers

Take a legal sized piece of paper and fold it in half.

Fold it in half again to make four boxes, as shown.

In the top left hand corner, write **In 3 months.** In the top right hand corner, write **In 6 months.** In the bottom left hand corner, write **In 1 year.** In the bottom right hand corner, write **In 5 years.**

In 3 months	In 6 months
In 1 year	In 5 years

Draw pictures of what you want your life to look like at these different points in your life. Think about your possible self — your hopes and dreams. Draw what is possible.

IV. Activities

- **Building Bridges** (directions included)
- **Spoons or Tongues** (directions included)
- **Improve This** (directions included)

V. Goals

- Goal — a clear statement of what you want to achieve and are working toward, and when you expect to achieve it **(Empower Your Future, Part I)**.
- Define short term, long term, and transitional goals
- Identify short-term (3 months), long-term, (5 years) and transitional goals (6 months and 1 year) in your drawings
- Create three specific, measurable, action-oriented short term goals with clear timelines. Include your action plan (steps) to reach your goal.
- Identify and prioritize five long term goals (think of your possible self — breaking out of the box)

VI. Read Overview of the 10 Steps to Success

Real-World Application: *Share at least one short term goal with three people in your lives, and ask them to support you in reaching your goal — and check in to make sure you are sticking to your plan.*

Building Bridges

Learning Objective: To introduce the idea of teamwork, communication and creative problem solving.

Group Size: Small groups of 5-7 people.

Space Required: a room with ample space for movement.

Props Required: Lots of newspaper, rolls (6-8) of masking tape, a gallon jug 1/4 to 1/2 full of water, a plastic dishpan type container, cassette player, cassette tape with "William Tell Overture" or music with a hectic pace.

Activity Instructions: "You are going to build a bridge using only the newspaper and masking tape. The bridge must be strong enough to hold this bottle (show the bottle and let them check the feel of it for weight). Also, the bridge must be tall enough for the pan to pass underneath it. The bridge must be free-standing — not attached to the wall, not a piece of furniture, not a person or an article of clothing...FREE-STANDING."

Have participants count off so that they are divided into teams.

Rules Summary: (Clarify understanding of rules. I also write them on flip chart).

You cannot use materials other than newspaper and masking tape.

Each group must build a bridge that the dish can pass under and hold the gallon jug for 10 seconds.

You cannot stick/tape to another person or furniture.

You have 5 minutes to plan, 8 minutes to build the bridge.

Process:

Tell them they will have 5 minutes to plan, discuss, etc., and to be sure everyone in the group is included. DO THEY HAVE ANY QUESTIONS? Time the 5 minutes. After the 5 minute discussion period, pass out the newspaper and tape. Inform the group they will now have 8 minutes to construct their bridge and, by the way, there will be no talking allowed during this 8 minutes.

At the end of 8 minutes, allow the groups 30 seconds to speak to each other and then an additional 3 minutes of SILENT work to complete their bridge. During this last work session, play the "William Tell Overture" (or other such music) loudly.

Call time and have one group at a time present their bridge. A spokesperson from each group will tell about their bridge and pass the pan under and put the jug on top. When the jug is put on top, all will count for 10 seconds. (This will be done for each group).

Processing/discussion questions:

- How did you work as a group?
- Which part was the most difficult?
- Did everyone participate in some way?
- Did you feel like you contributed to the group?
- Did you feel like you were part of the group?
- Was there one particular person that kept the ball rolling?
- Were there individuals who were particularly quiet?
- How was their quietness interpreted: agreement or disagreement?
- What influenced the type of bridge built by each group?
- Why were no two alike?
- How did communication or lack of it affect the work of the group?
- What characteristics of teamwork became evident during this exercise?

Adapted from **http://www.firststepstraining.com/resources/activities/archive/activity_bridges.htm** retrieved 3-24-10

Spoons or Tongues

Players: 3 to 13 players. Best with 6 to 13 players.

Supplies: A standard 52-card deck.
For Spoons: One spoon for each player except one. *EXAMPLE: With 8 players, you need 7 spoons.*

Goal: To be the first to collect four cards of the same rank. If an opponent beats you to that goal, to not be the last to realize it and grab a spoon or stick out your tongue.

Setup: For each player in the game, you need four cards of the same rank from the deck.
For example, with 5 players you could use the Aces, 2s, 3s, 4s and 5s.

Shuffle the cards and deal them to the players. Each player will have four cards.

If you're playing Spoons, put the spoons in the middle of the table so that every player can reach them.

Gameplay:

- Players simultaneously choose one card from their hands, pass that card to the opponent on their left, and pick up the card they've received from the opponent on their right. Each player can never have more than five cards in her/his hand, so it's illegal for a player to pick up more than one new card before passing one to the left.
- When a player collects four of a kind, as subtly as possible, he or she needs to take a spoon and place it in front of himself/herself (or if you do not have spoons, the person needs to stick out his/her tongue).
- When one player has four of a kind, every other player is allowed to subtly pick up a spoon (or stick out their tongue) as well. The last player to grab a spoon or stick out his/her tongue gets a letter (S-P-O-O-N or T-O-N-G-U-E)
- Players who either take a spoon or stick out their tongue should continue to pick up and pass cards, making it more difficult for other players to realize what has happened. (The player who actually collected four cards of the same rank must always pass the card they just picked up, because passing any other card would break up their four-of-a-kind).

Winning:

The final two players in the game are co-winners. (I don't usually play long enough for anyone to spell S-P-O-O-N; it is more fun with everyone playing).

Adapted from **http://boardgames.about.com/od/cardgames/a/spoons.htm** April 8 2010

Discussion Questions:

- What did you notice during this game?
- How does this game relate to work? (multi-tasking, goals, prioritizing, observation, focus, dealing with different personalities, dealing with frustration, fun, putting things in perspective — is it worth getting upset about?)
- What was the goal of the game? (short-term to get four of a kind, ultimate/long-term to get a spoon/ stick out your tongue)
- What were you focused on — getting four of a kind or getting a spoon? What is your priority?
- What can you learn from this game?

Improve This

A very quick activity in which participants try to improve their seating arrangement with no specific goal in mind.

Purpose: Participants learn that objectives or goals must be specific and that assumptions left unchecked can sabotage an effort.

Use this when:

- Individuals need to see the value of setting clear and specific goals.
- Individuals are making assumptions or not asking questions for clarification.
- You don't have prep time and/or materials for anything more elaborate.

No materials needed

Directions:

1. Announce to the group that they have exactly 60 seconds to improve their seating arrangement.
2. Do not give any further instruction. Look at a clock and tell them to begin… now!
3. If they ask for clarification, simply repeat the original instructions.
4. Stop the activity after 60 seconds and discuss.

Discussion Questions:

- Did you meet your objective? (Possible answers you may hear: yes, because I am closer to the window; no, because I'm not sure what the objective was; I'm not sure…)
- What was your objective? Was it clear? (If they think it was clear, ask them to define "improve," and then show how it could have meant to get more people up front, or to get in a (better) circle, or to sit in small groups etc. — to show there were assumptions made).
- Did you seek clarification? Why not? Or what happened when you tried?
- How does this situation relate to the workplace or life? (We often try to accomplish things when we are not clear on the goal or the specific criteria for success. We often don't ask for clarification [or clarify and specify our own goals] and if we do, we don't always press to get what we truly need to succeed.)
- What can we do to prevent this type of thing from happening?

Tips for Success:

- After giving the instructions, do not ask if there are any questions. Look at the clock to discourage their questions. It is amazing how quickly anyone wanting clarification will back off if the source appears elusive. Usually the pressure of the group will discourage anyone from not moving quickly.
- If they directly ask for clarification, say, *"You determine for yourselves what "improve" means. You are all intelligent. It seems pretty obvious."* During the debrief, point out how similar this is to responses at school, at work, in their lives.
- Do not be surprised (and do not stop them) if they start moving tables and chairs to "improve" their seating arrangement.
- As they rearrange themselves, listen to their comments. They may say things such as. " I don't know what she wants, but let's try this…" Bring these up (without pointing out who said what) during the discussion.

From *Quick Team Building Activities for Busy Managers* by Brian Cole Miller p 129-131

Overview of the 10 Steps to Success

ATTITUDE: Your attitude is the strongest (or weakest) aspect about you. It will determine your self-image and how well or poorly you do at everything. No more "I can't."

GOALS: Succeeding and seeing results should be a lot easier if you know what YOU want. If you enjoy what you're doing and you're getting better, you'll want to do it more. The goals become even bigger and better.

OBJECTIVES: These are the "little things" that constantly focus your attention on the information that will make a difference. The benefits of attaining your objectives daily create a remarkable determination to reach your goals.

ORGANIZATION: Once you are on the path to accomplishing your objectives and goals, you'll want to reach your outcome faster. The best in every class, in every sport and every area of life learn that time is very precious. It needs to be used wisely.

INSPIRATION: It is inevitable: we all get knocked down physically and mentally. When you were just a baby, you fell down but got back up; otherwise, you would be crawling everywhere. However, staying focused on your goals and objectives can be challenging at times. Don't lose sight of "why" you want those goals.

COMMITMENT: You will face challenges from friends, classmates, teachers, and even people you don't know. It is GOING TO HAPPEN. You can plan ahead of time that there will be pitfalls. Top performers and successful people always embrace the pitfalls but staying committed to their goals.

LEADERSHIP: When you set out to accomplish something, friends notice. It creates a level of confidence, courage and determination in you. Little by little, people start to see and wonder how they can get the same results. People start to follow!

ACCOUNTABILITY: You have finally learned that there is no more blaming your challenges, failures or circumstances on other people. If there is something to get done, a decision that needs to be made or a challenge to be met, you have proven you can do it. "If it's going to be, it's up to me."

GOOD CHOICES, BAD CHOICES, IT'S UP TO YOU: So now your friends depend on you. They watch what you say and, more importantly, what you do. So your choices and decisions will impact many. There is no "pressure" on you because you are confident you can make your own choices, as opposed to the group's choices.

SUCCESS SYSTEM: If you follow the system, you might reap the rewards!!

From **http://jimbrogan.com/** retrieved April 8, 2010